STATISTICS & MACHINE LEARNING · LESSON 27 OF 30

Explainable AI and MLOps: SHAP, Fairness, Deployment, Monitoring and Responsible ML

Make models trustworthy and useful in production. Global and local explanations (permutation importance, partial dependence, SHAP), fairness checks across groups, packaging a pipeline, serving predictions with FastAPI, batch scoring, experiment tracking with MLflow, monitoring data drift and performance, model cards, and the regulations and responsible-AI practices that apply in India and globally.

ML track (added) · ✦ SHAP 0.4x · FastAPI · MLflow 3 · 2026 practice · Advanced · ⏱ 130 min

By the end of this lesson you can

- Explain a model globally with permutation importance and partial dependence
- Explain individual predictions with SHAP values and communicate them
- Check performance and error rates across groups for fairness
- Package, serve and batch-score a model, and track experiments
- Monitor drift and performance after deployment and document models with model cards

Datasets used

`telecom_churn.csv`

Why explainability?

Stakeholders ask "**why** did the model say this?". Regulators require explanations for credit and insurance decisions; data scientists need explanations to debug leakage and bias.

Python

```
import pandas as pd, numpy as np, warnings
warnings.filterwarnings("ignore")
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
from sklearn.ensemble import HistGradientBoostingClassifier
from sklearn.metrics import roc_auc_score
tc = pd.read_csv("telecom_churn.csv")
X = pd.get_dummies(tc.drop(columns=["customer_id", "churn", "total_charges"]),
drop_first=True).astype(float); y = (tc.churn == "Yes").astype(int)
Xtr, Xte, ytr, yte = train_test_split(X, y, test_size=0.3, stratify=y, random_state=1)
model = HistGradientBoostingClassifier(max_iter=200, learning_rate=0.05, max_leaf_nodes=15,
min_samples_leaf=40, random_state=0).fit(Xtr, ytr)
print(f"test AUC {roc_auc_score(yte, model.predict_proba(Xte)[:, 1]):.3f} | features:
{list(X.columns)}")
```

OUTPUT

```
test AUC 0.801 | features: ['senior_citizen', 'tenure_months', 'monthly_charges',
'support_calls', 'contract_One year', 'contract_Two year', 'internet_service_Fiber',
'internet_service_No internet', 'payment_method_Card', 'payment_method_Net banking',
'payment_method_UPI']
```

Scope	Question	Methods
Global	Which features matter overall, and how?	Permutation importance, partial dependence, SHAP summary
Local	Why this prediction for this customer?	SHAP values, LIME, counterfactuals
Interpretable by design	Can the model itself be read?	Linear/logistic models, small trees, scorecards, EBMs

Global: permutation importance

Python

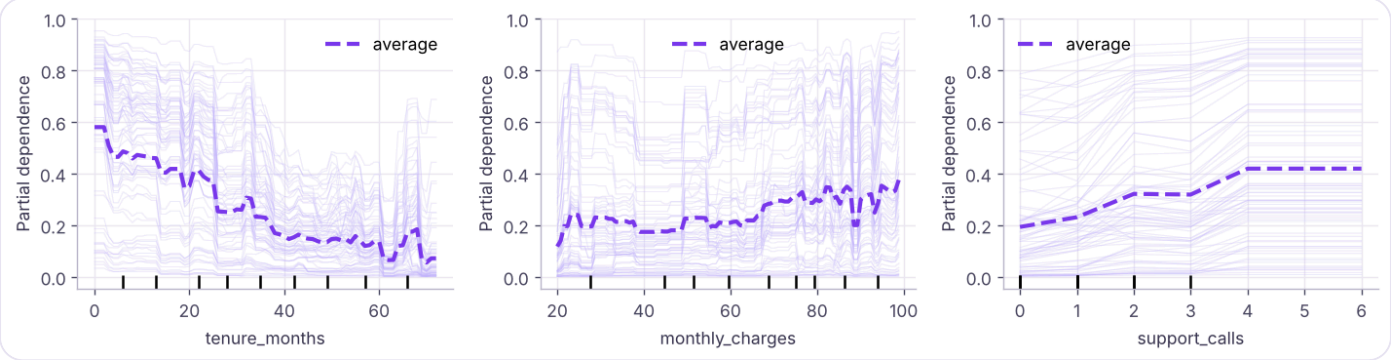
```
from sklearn.inspection import permutation_importance
pi = permutation_importance(model, Xte, yte, scoring="roc_auc", n_repeats=15,
random_state=0)
imp = pd.DataFrame({"mean_AUC_drop": pi.importances_mean, "std": pi.importances_std},
index=X.columns).sort_values("mean_AUC_drop", ascending=False)
print(imp.round(4))
```

OUTPUT

	mean_AUC_drop	std
tenure_months	0.1541	0.0142
contract_Two year	0.0783	0.0121
contract_One year	0.0420	0.0102
monthly_charges	0.0352	0.0123
support_calls	0.0306	0.0071
internet_service_Fiber	0.0026	0.0021
internet_service_No internet	0.0020	0.0016
senior_citizen	0.0006	0.0010
payment_method_UPI	0.0006	0.0012
payment_method_Net banking	0.0005	0.0023
payment_method_Card	0.0001	0.0013

Shuffle one column in the test set and measure how much the score drops: model-agnostic and honest about held-out performance. Correlated features share credit, so treat their importances together.

Global: partial dependence



Partial dependence: average predicted churn probability as one feature changes, holding others as observed. Thin lines (ICE) show individual customers.

Churn falls steeply in the first two years of tenure, rises with monthly charges and with each extra support call: consistent with the EDA, which builds trust in the model.

Local: SHAP values

SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) splits each prediction into contributions from each feature, based on Shapley values from cooperative game theory:

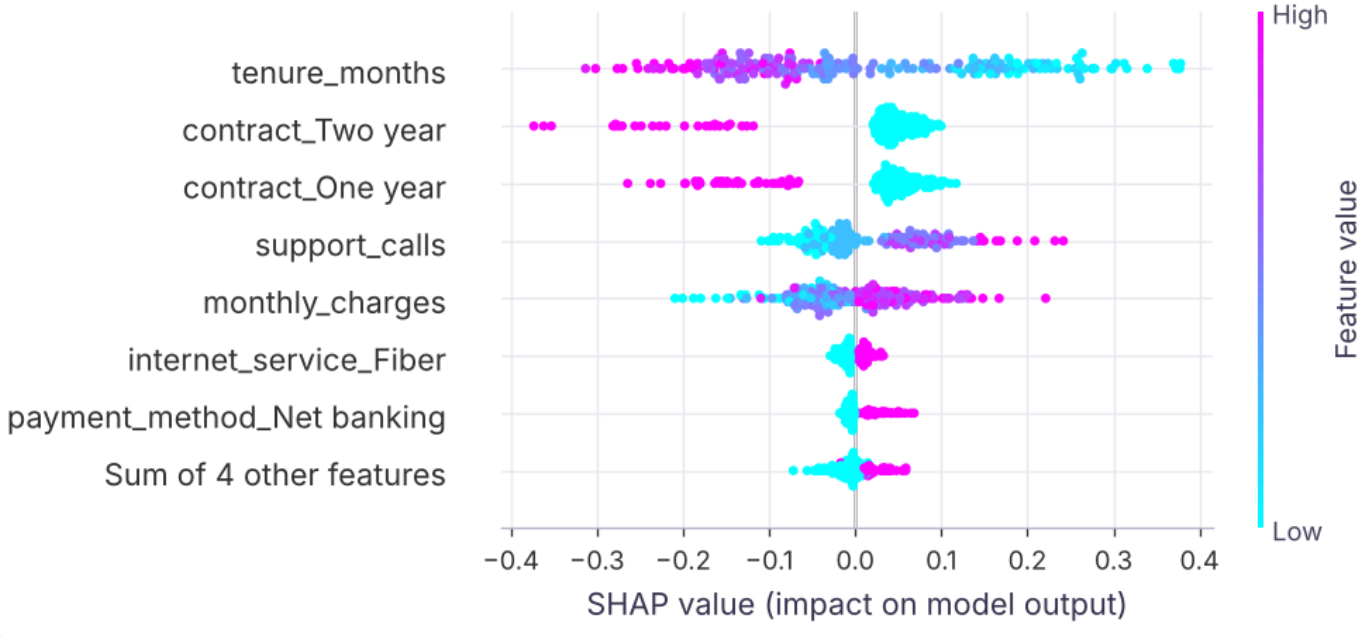
$$f(x) = \text{base value} + \sum_j \phi_j(x)$$

Python

```
import shap
explainer = shap.Explainer(model.predict_proba, shap.maskers.Independent(Xtr,
max_samples=200), feature_names=list(X.columns))
sample = Xte.iloc[:200]
sv = explainer(sample, silent=True)[..., 1]                                    #
contributions to P(churn)
print("SHAP values shape:", sv.values.shape, "| base value (average prediction):",
round(float(sv.base_values[0]), 3))
mean_abs = pd.Series(np.abs(sv.values).mean(0),
index=X.columns).sort_values(ascending=False)
print("mean |SHAP| (global importance):", mean_abs.round(4).head(6).to_dict())
```

OUTPUT

```
SHAP values shape: (200, 11) | base value (average prediction): 0.245
mean |SHAP| (global importance): {'tenure_months': 0.1417, 'contract_Two year':
0.0715, 'contract_One year': 0.0702, 'support_calls': 0.0555, 'monthly_charges':
0.0552, 'internet_service_Fiber': 0.012}
```



SHAP summary (beeswarm): each dot is a customer; position = effect on churn probability, colour = feature value (pink high, purple low).

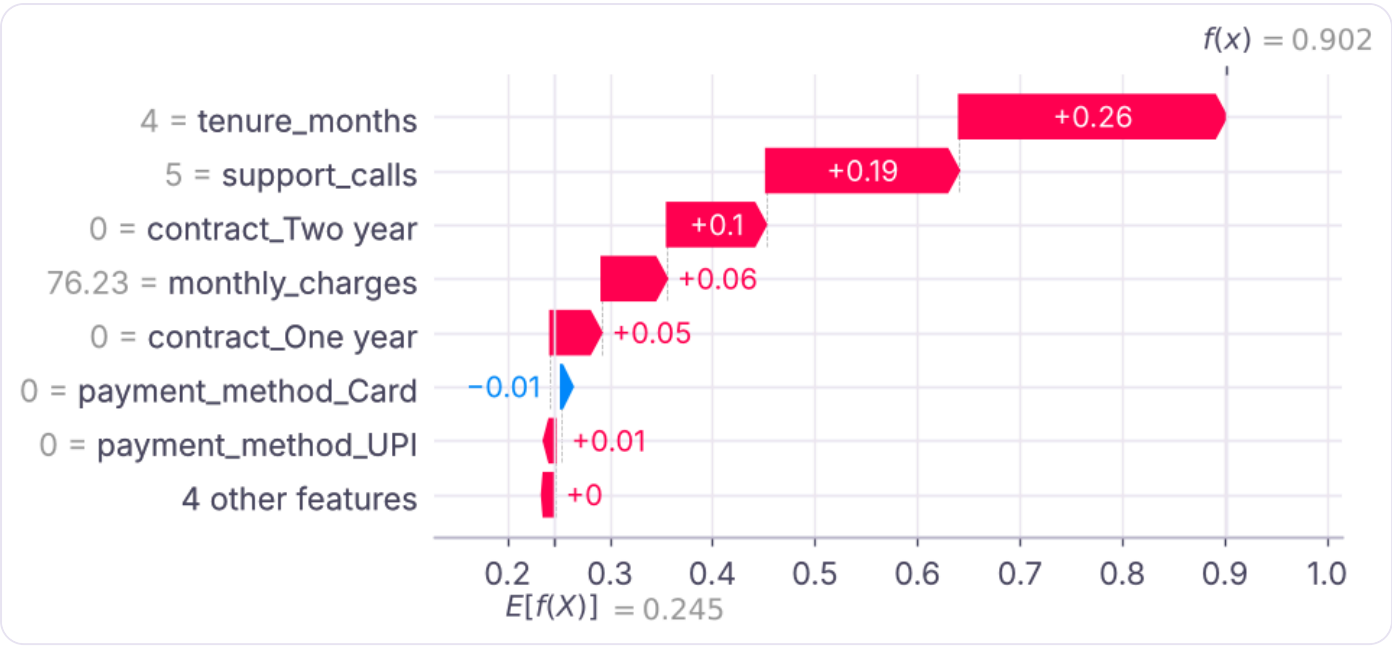
Explaining one customer

Python

```
probs = model.predict_proba(sample)[:, 1]; i = int(np.argmax(probs))
row = pd.DataFrame({"value": sample.iloc[i], "shap": sv.values[i]}).sort_values("shap",
key=abs, ascending=False)
print(f"customer {tc.loc[sample.index[i], 'customer_id']}: P(churn) = {probs[i]:.2f} = base
{sv.base_values[i]:.2f} + contributions:")
print(row.head(6).round(3))
def reason(f, v):
    name = f.replace("_", " ")
    if X[f].isin([0, 1]).all() and "_" in f and f not in ("senior_citizen",): return f"not
on '{f.split('_', 1)[1]}' {f.split('_')[0]}" if v == 0 else f"{f.split('_', 1)[1]}
{f.split('_')[0]}"
    return f"{name} = {v:g}"
reasons = [reason(f, v) for f, v in row[row.shap > 0].value.head(3).items()]
print("Top reasons for the retention agent:", "; ".join(reasons))
```

OUTPUT

```
customer T00216: P(churn) = 0.90 = base 0.25 + contributions:
                     value   shap
tenure_months         4.00  0.261
support_calls         5.00  0.188
contract_Two year     0.00  0.097
monthly_charges      76.23  0.064
contract_One year     0.00  0.050
payment_method_Card   0.00 -0.010
Top reasons for the retention agent: tenure months = 4; support calls = 5; not on
'Two year' contract
```



Waterfall plot for the highest-risk customer: how each feature moves the prediction from the average to the final probability.

`shap.TreeExplainer` is much faster for tree models (XGBoost, LightGBM, random forests); `shap.LinearExplainer` for linear models. Explanations describe the **model**, not causal effects in the real world.

Fairness checks

A model can be accurate overall and still treat groups differently. Check metrics **by group** for sensitive attributes (gender, age, region, language).

Python

```
from sklearn.metrics import recall_score, precision_score
t = 0.4; pred = model.predict_proba(Xte)[:, 1] ≥ t
grp = np.where(Xte.senior_citizen == 1, "senior", "non-senior")
rows = []
for g in ["non-senior", "senior"]:
    m = grp == g
    rows.append({"group": g, "n": int(m.sum()), "actual churn": round(yte[m].mean(), 3),
"flagged rate": round(pred[m].mean(), 3), "recall": round(recall_score(yte[m], pred[m]),
3), "precision": round(precision_score(yte[m], pred[m]), 3), "AUC":
round(roc_auc_score(yte[m], model.predict_proba(Xte[m])[:, 1]), 3)})
print(pd.DataFrame(rows).to_string(index=False))
```

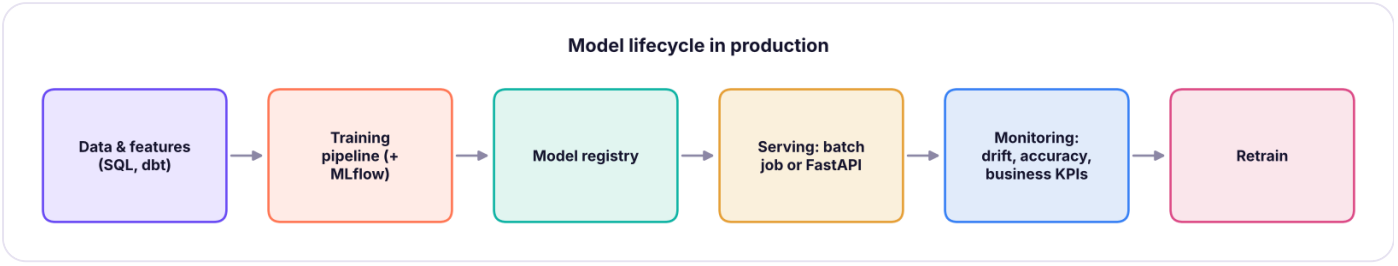
OUTPUT

```
     group   n  actual churn  flagged rate  recall  precision   AUC
non-senior 758         0.245         0.243   0.538      0.543 0.806
    senior 142         0.324         0.254   0.565      0.722 0.783
```

Fairness notion	Asks	Note
Demographic parity	Same positive (flag) rate across groups?	Ignores real differences in base rates
Equal opportunity	Same recall (true-positive rate)?	Common for benefits such as retention offers
Equalised odds	Same TPR and FPR?	Stricter
Calibration within groups	Does 30% mean 30% in every group?	Important for risk scores

The definitions can conflict; choose with domain experts and legal advice, document the choice, and remove proxies for protected attributes where required. Tools: **Fairlearn**, **AIF360**.

From notebook to production



A minimal MLOps architecture.

1. Package the pipeline and track the experiment

Python

```
import joblib, json, sklearn, os, datetime
os.makedirs("artifacts", exist_ok=True)
joblib.dump(model, "artifacts/churn_model.joblib")
card = {"model": "churn HistGradientBoosting", "trained": datetime.date(2026, 1,
15).isoformat(), "sklearn": sklearn.__version__, "features": list(X.columns),
        "test_auc": round(roc_auc_score(yte, model.predict_proba(Xte)[:, 1]), 3),
"threshold": t, "intended_use": "monthly retention targeting; not for pricing or credit
decisions",
        "training_data": "telecom_churn.csv, 3,000 customers, churn rate 25.7%",
"limitations": "no usage or complaint text features; senior customers under-represented"}
json.dump(card, open("artifacts/model_card.json", "w"), indent=2)
print(sorted(os.listdir("artifacts")), "|", json.load(open("artifacts/model_card.json"))
["intended_use"])
```

OUTPUT

```
['churn_model.joblib', 'model_card.json'] | monthly retention targeting; not for
pricing or credit decisions
```

Python

```
# Experiment tracking with MLflow (pip install mlflow; run `mlflow ui` to browse)
import mlflow
with mlflow.start_run(run_name="hgb_v3"):
    mlflow.log_params({"learning_rate": 0.05, "max_leaf_nodes": 15})
    mlflow.log_metric("test_auc", 0.80)
    mlflow.sklearn.log_model(model, name="churn_model", registered_model_name="churn")
```

2. Serve predictions with an API

Python

```
from fastapi import FastAPI
from fastapi.testclient import TestClient
from pydantic import BaseModel, Field
app = FastAPI(title="Churn scoring API")
mdl = joblib.load("artifacts/churn_model.joblib"); FEATS = card["features"]
class Customer(BaseModel):
    senior_citizen: int = Field(ge=0, le=1); tenure_months: int = Field(ge=0);
monthly_charges: float = Field(gt=0); support_calls: int = Field(ge=0)
    contract: str; internet_service: str; payment_method: str
@app.post("/predict")
def predict(c: Customer):
    row = pd.get_dummies(pd.DataFrame([c.model_dump()])).reindex(columns=FEATS,
fill_value=0).astype(float)
    p = float(mdl.predict_proba(row)[0, 1])
    return {"churn_probability": round(p, 3), "flag_for_retention": p ⩾ card["threshold"],
"model_version": card["trained"]}
client = TestClient(app)
r = client.post("/predict", json={"senior_citizen": 0, "tenure_months": 2,
"monthly_charges": 99.5, "support_calls": 4, "contract": "Month-to-month",
"internet_service": "Fiber", "payment_method": "UPI"})
print(r.status_code, r.json())
print(client.post("/predict", json={"senior_citizen": 3, "tenure_months": -1,
"monthly_charges": 50, "support_calls": 0, "contract": "x", "internet_service": "y",
"payment_method": "z"}).status_code, "(invalid input rejected)")
```

OUTPUT

```
200 {'churn_probability': 0.942, 'flag_for_retention': True, 'model_version': '2026-
01-15'}
422 (invalid input rejected)
```

Run it for real with `uvicorn app:app --reload`, containerise with **Docker**, and deploy to a cloud service (AWS SageMaker, Azure ML, Google Vertex AI, Cloud Run, Render). Many business models do not need an API at all: a nightly **batch job** that writes scores to a database table feeding the CRM or a Power BI dashboard is simpler and cheaper.

3. Monitor

Python

```
from scipy.stats import ks_2samp
def psi(expected, actual, bins=10):
    edges = np.unique(np.quantile(expected, np.linspace(0, 1, bins + 1))); edges[0],
edges[-1] = -np.inf, np.inf
    e = np.histogram(expected, edges)[0] / len(expected); a = np.histogram(actual, edges)
[0] / len(actual)
    e, a = np.clip(e, 1e-4, None), np.clip(a, 1e-4, None); return float(((a - e) * np.log(a
/ e)).sum())
rng = np.random.default_rng(0)
new_month = Xte.copy(); new_month["monthly_charges"] = new_month.monthly_charges * 1.12 +
rng.normal(0, 3, len(new_month))   # simulated price increase
for col in ["tenure_months", "monthly_charges", "support_calls"]:
    print(f"{col:16s} PSI {psi(Xtr[col], new_month[col]):.3f} | KS p-value
{ks_2samp(Xtr[col], new_month[col]).pvalue:.3g}")
print("PSI guide: < 0.1 stable | 0.1–0.25 watch | > 0.25 significant shift → investigate /
retrain")
```

OUTPUT

```
tenure_months    PSI 0.022 | KS p-value 0.294
monthly_charges  PSI 0.538 | KS p-value 1.36e-11
support_calls    PSI 0.004 | KS p-value 0.808
PSI guide: < 0.1 stable | 0.1–0.25 watch | > 0.25 significant shift → investigate /
retrain
```

Monitor	Why
Input drift (PSI, KS tests)	The population changed (new pricing, new channel)
Prediction drift	Score distribution shifts
Performance (once labels arrive)	AUC, recall at threshold, calibration
Business KPIs	Retention rate, campaign ROI (via A/B holdouts)
Data quality	Missing values, schema changes, pipeline failures

Tools: Evidently, WhyLabs, Arize, cloud-native monitors; schedule retraining or trigger it when drift or decay crosses thresholds.

Responsible AI and regulation

- **Privacy:** India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (and its 2025 rules), GDPR in Europe: lawful purpose, consent, data minimisation and the right to erasure.

- **Credit and lending:** RBI guidelines on digital lending expect transparency on decisions; lenders must be able to explain adverse decisions.
- **EU AI Act** (phased in from 2025–2027): risk tiers; high-risk systems (credit scoring, hiring) need risk management, documentation, human oversight and logging.
- **Practice:** model cards and datasheets, human review for high-impact decisions, bias testing before launch, red-teaming GenAI systems, and an incident process.

```python
import shutil; shutil.rmtree("artifacts")
```

Summary

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Global explanations: permutation importance (held-out) and partial dependence; local explanations: SHAP values that sum from the base value to the prediction.
- Check metrics by group (recall, precision, calibration) and choose a fairness definition with domain experts.
- Production means a versioned pipeline, model card, experiment tracking, serving (batch or API with input validation) and monitoring.
- Monitor input drift (PSI/KS), prediction drift, performance and business KPIs; retrain on a schedule or on triggers.
- Follow privacy and AI regulations (DPDP Act, RBI, EU AI Act) and keep humans in the loop for high-impact decisions.

Quick quiz

6 questions · tap an answer to check it

1. What does permutation importance measure?

- **A** How much the held-out score drops when a feature's values are shuffled
- **B** The coefficient size
- **C** The number of splits
- **D** Correlation with the target

Answer: A. Model-agnostic.

2. SHAP values for one prediction add up to...

- **A** The prediction minus the base (average) prediction
- **B** 1
- **C** The number of features
- **D** The AUC

Answer: A. Additive explanations.

3. Which fairness notion asks for equal recall across groups?

- **A** Demographic parity
- **B** Equal opportunity
- **C** Calibration
- **D** Accuracy parity

Answer: B. Equal true-positive rates.

4. **A PSI of 0.4 on monthly charges means...**

A A significant shift in that input's distribution; investigate and consider retraining

B The model is perfect

C No change

D 40% accuracy

Answer: A.

> 0.25 is a large shift.

5. **When is a nightly batch job better than a real-time API?**

A When decisions are made daily or weekly, e.g. retention campaigns

B Never

C For fraud at payment time

D When latency must be under 50 ms

Answer: A. Simpler and cheaper.

6. What belongs in a model card?

A Intended use, training data, metrics, limitations and version

B Only the code

C Customer passwords

D The test set

Answer: A. Documentation for users and auditors.

EXERCISE **Practice**

(1) Use `shap.TreeExplainer` on an XGBoost churn model and compare top features with permutation importance. (2) Check recall by `internet_service` at your threshold. (3) Write the FastAPI app as a file, run it with uvicorn, and call it with `requests`. (4) Simulate drift in `tenure_months` and compute PSI.

Show solution (worked answer)

Python

```
import xgboost as xgb
xm = xgb.XGBClassifier(n_estimators=300, learning_rate=0.05, max_depth=3).fit(Xtr,
ytr)
ts = shap.TreeExplainer(xm)(Xte); print(pd.Series(np.abs(ts.values).mean(0),
index=X.columns).sort_values(ascending=False).head())
for col in ["internet_service_Fiber", "internet_service_No internet"]:
    m = Xte[col] == 1; print(col, recall_score(yte[m], pred[m]))
shifted = Xte.tenure_months * 0.7; print(psi(Xtr.tenure_months, shifted))
```

INTERVIEW CORNER

Questions you may be asked

Q: How do you explain a black-box model to business users? Show global drivers (permutation importance, partial dependence) in plain language, give per-customer top reasons from SHAP, validate that they match domain knowledge, and state clearly that they describe the model, not causation.

Q: What can go wrong after a model is deployed? Data drift, concept drift (relationships change), pipeline bugs, feedback loops, degraded performance for some groups, and business processes ignoring the scores; monitoring and A/B holdouts catch these.

Q: How do you check a model for bias? Compare performance and error rates across groups, check calibration per group, look for proxy features, involve domain and legal experts, and mitigate (reweighting, thresholds, removing proxies) with documentation.

Practise more online

Free, trusted places to test yourself on this topic. Links open the original site in a new tab.